

Subject: Fwd: Town Meeting Report Packets can be picked up now
From: Chris Loreti <cloreti@verizon.net>
Date: 4/15/25, 12:23
To: Stephen Harrington <sth.alist@gmail.com>, Mark Kaepplein <markk02474@gmail.com>

Thought you might find this email string amusing. Christiana thought he should act as the speech police on an email I copied him on.

Chris

----- Forwarded Message -----

Subject: Re: Town Meeting Report Packets can be picked up now
Date: Tue, 15 Apr 2025 11:54:34 -0400
From: Chris Loreti <cloreti@verizon.net>
To: Greg Christiana <gchristiana@town.arlington.ma.us>, Lenard Diggins <ldiggins@gmail.com>
CC: Diane Mahon <dmahon@town.arlington.ma.us>, Stephen DeCoursey <sdeCoursey@town.arlington.ma.us>, John Hurd <jhurd@town.arlington.ma.us>, Eric Helmuth <ehelmuth@town.arlington.ma.us>, Len Diggins <ldiggins@town.arlington.ma.us>, Jim Feeney <jfeeney@town.arlington.ma.us>, Juli Brazile <jbrazile@town.arlington.ma.us>

Hello Greg,

To be clear, I checked with Town Counsel before starting my last term as a TMM and he confirmed that the Town Meeting oath of office was strictly optional. (I hope you will make this clear at the beginning of this year's Town Meeting.) I did not take it. So do I not feel bound by it.

I did not take it because I find the attempts to control free speech with claims of incivility, as you have demonstrated in your message below, extremely offensive.

I hope you don't find this message too offensive.

Sincerely,

Chris Loreti P7

On 4/15/2025 11:45 AM, Greg Christiana wrote:

Hi all,

To be clear, I don't consider the Town Meeting Procedures Committee to be an essential decisionmaker about the distribution of Town Meeting packets. For my part, I appreciate the effort that the Select Board, Town staff, and volunteers put into collecting and printing the packet materials and making them available in a timely manner, regardless of the personal or professional capacity in which they do it.

I would also like to remind everyone of the Town Meeting Member oath of office which I consider applicable when individuals are operating in their capacity as Town Meeting Members. It reads in part:

I support free speech and will treat others with mutual respect and will conduct myself in a civil manner that is becoming of an elected Town Meeting Member.

I have difficulty reconciling an accusation of dysfunction – given the significant effort that goes into the production of the packets and the timeliness of their availability – with a civil manner. The goal of civility in this context is not politeness, but effectiveness. And the more time and effort that we all spend on incivility and its deleterious effects is unfortunate and avoidable.

An even higher bar than civility is thoughtfulness. And while the oath doesn't hold us to that higher bar, it behooves all of us to reflect on the manner in which we pursue better outcomes.

Sincerely,

Greg Christiana
Arlington Town Moderator
781-819-2781

From: Chris Loreti <cloreti@verizon.net>

Sent: Tuesday, April 15, 2025 11:23 AM

To: Lenard Diggins <ldiggins@gmail.com>

Cc: Diane Mahon <dmahon@town.arlington.ma.us>; Stephen DeCoursey <sdeCoursey@town.arlington.ma.us>; John Hurd <jhurd@town.arlington.ma.us>; Eric Helmuth <ehelmuth@town.arlington.ma.us>; Len Diggins <ldiggins@town.arlington.ma.us>; Jim Feeney <jfeeney@town.arlington.ma.us>; Greg Christiana <gchristiana@town.arlington.ma.us>; Juli Brazile <jbrazile@town.arlington.ma.us>

Subject: Fwd: Town Meeting Report Packets can be picked up now

CAUTION: This email originated from outside your organization. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking links, especially from unknown senders.

Hello Len,

I am not able to get to Town Hall this week to pick up my Town Meeting materials. I would appreciate it if the material could be mailed or otherwise delivered to my home.

But I have to wonder why I should even have to ask for this as if it's a special favor. Past

practice was to deliver packets to all TMMs. Greg Christiana was not aware of action the Town Meeting Procedures Committee took to do change this. Did the Select Board vote to make this change? If so, can you tell me at which meeting. I'd like to review the tape.

And I also wonder about your particular role in the distribution. Are you doing this as a private citizen? (Using a personal email address?) Or as a Select Board member? (If the latter, you should be using your town email address.) That you are involved at all seems to me to reflect a profound lack of professionalism in the way our Town government works. Is the Town so dysfunctional that the Select Board can't direct the Town Manager to have Town staff mail or deliver the packets to any TMMs who want them. Or is this just a reflection of how little regard the Select Board has for Town Meeting?

In any case, thanks in advance for getting a hard copy packet to me. I hope the Town can do better in the future.

Chris Loreti, P7

----- Forwarded Message -----

Subject:Town Meeting Report Packets can be picked up now

Date:Tue, 15 Apr 2025 12:53:58 +0000

From:Juli Brazile <jbrazile@town.arlington.ma.us>

To:Juli Brazile <jbrazile@town.arlington.ma.us>

Hello again!

I realize there has been some confusion about how you can get your paper packets containing the Moderator's Letter and Consent Agenda, and reports from the Select Board, Redevelopment Board, Finance Committee, Capital Planning, Community Preservation, and CDBG. **They are now available at the Select Board's Office for pick up today, tomorrow and Thursday.** The Select Board's Office is on the 2nd floor of Town Hall, and it's open from 8AM-4PM on Tuesdays and Wednesdays and from 8AM-7PM on Thursdays.

If you are unable to go to Town Hall to get a packet, let [Len Diggins LDiggins@gmail.com](mailto:LDiggins@gmail.com) know so he can arrange to get you a packet sometime next week or during the first session of Town Meeting. If you offer to pick up a packet for a friend, please be sure they know so they don't also arrive at Town Hall and wonder where it is.

Juli

Juliana H Brazile
Arlington Town Clerk
730 Massachusetts Avenue
Arlington, MA 02476
781-316-3071

Arlington values equity, diversity, and inclusion. We are committed to building a community where everyone is heard, respected, and protected.